

Prism MVP Build Spec

Product Goal

Prism helps people explore unfamiliar topics by dynamically organizing information through different perspectives.

Instead of requiring users to search, filter, or browse through predefined structures, Prism helps users understand information through the perspective that is most useful for their current goal.

Target User

Curious learners exploring unfamiliar topics who know what they want to understand but do not know the best path through the information.

Examples:

- Someone learning a new subject
- Someone researching a purchase decision
- Someone exploring a new hobby or interest

Core User Experience

1. Enter a Topic

The user enters a topic they want to explore.

Examples:

- Coffee
- Electric vehicles
- Photography

2. Generate Perspectives

Prism analyzes the topic and generates multiple ways to explore it.

Example:

Topic: Coffee

Perspectives:

- Beginner — “Help me understand the basics”
- Buyer — “Help me choose the right option”
- Scientist — “Help me understand how it works”
- Environmentalist — “Help me understand the impact”
- Historian — “Help me understand its origins”

3. Select a Perspective

The user chooses the perspective most relevant to their goal.

4. Explore the Topic

Prism reorganizes the topic through the selected perspective.

The experience should show:

- Key concepts
- Relationships between concepts
- Suggested exploration paths

MVP Features

Feature 1: Topic Input

Users can enter any topic they want to explore.

Input:

- Topic name
- Optional goal or question

Example:

“I want to understand electric vehicles before buying one.”

Feature 2: AI-Generated Perspectives

The system generates 4–6 relevant perspectives based on the topic and user intent.

Examples:

- Beginner
- Expert
- Buyer
- Historical
- Technical
- Environmental

Feature 3: Perspective-Based Knowledge Exploration

After selecting a perspective, Prism generates a customized exploration experience.

The system should provide:

- Important concepts
- Relationships between concepts
- Recommended paths for deeper exploration

Feature 4: Knowledge Relationship Model

The backend should store relationships between concepts rather than only categories.

Example:

Coffee

Relationships:

- Coffee → originated in → Ethiopia
- Coffee → contains → Caffeine
- Coffee → impacts → Agriculture
- Coffee → requires → Roasting

Backend Data Model

User

Stores user information and exploration history.

Fields:

- User ID
- Name (optional)
- Previous topics explored
- Preferred perspectives (optional)

Topic

Represents a subject being explored.

Examples:

- Coffee
- Electric vehicles
- Photography

Fields:

- Topic ID
- Topic name
- Description
- Created date

Perspective

Represents different ways to understand a topic.

Examples:

- Beginner
- Buyer
- Engineer
- Environmentalist

Fields:

- Perspective ID

- Topic ID
- Perspective name
- Perspective description

Concept

Represents individual pieces of knowledge.

Examples:

- Battery technology
- Charging infrastructure
- Range

Fields:

- Concept ID
- Topic ID
- Concept name
- Description

Relationship

Represents connections between concepts.

Fields:

- Relationship ID
- Source concept
- Relationship type
- Target concept

Examples:

- Battery technology → impacts → Vehicle range
- Roasting → influences → Flavor

Backend Requirements

Prism should support:

- Storing topics and concepts
- Creating relationships between concepts
- Generating AI-powered perspectives
- Generating topic-specific exploration paths
- Saving exploration history

Demo Scenario

Example Topic: Coffee

User enters:

“Coffee”

Prism generates:

Beginner Perspective

“What is coffee and how does it work?”

Buyer Perspective

“How do I choose coffee?”

Science Perspective

“How do chemistry and roasting affect flavor?”

Sustainability Perspective

“How does coffee production impact the environment?”

Cultural Perspective

“How has coffee shaped societies?”

User selects a perspective and explores a reorganized view of the topic.

Success Criteria

A user should understand the product within 30 seconds:

“I enter a topic → Prism shows me different ways to understand it.”

A successful demo demonstrates:

1. User enters a topic
2. AI generates multiple perspectives
3. User selects a perspective
4. Information reorganizes around that perspective

Out of Scope for MVP

The first version will not include:

- Mobile app
- Browser extension
- Importing external data
- Personal knowledge management
- Social sharing
- Collaboration features
- Advanced personalization
- Full knowledge graph visualization

Design Principle

Information should adapt to the user's intent, not require users to adapt to the information system.